'Round the Mountainside

Quarterly newsletter for Coolfont Mountainside Association

Winter 2022

New Year, New Opportunites

by CMA Board

Happy New Year!

This new year brings opportunities for our owners and community. A new year is also the time to set goals, make resolutions, and plan work to maintain and improve our mountainside community.The past year presented several challenges for CMA, which were addressed through the steadfast work of our community volunteers and contractors.

In 2021, we established resolutions outlining CMA Policies, implemented online billing and payments, completed a water/sewer tariff review, brought all properites into septic maintenance compliance, rebuilt our website, revised our Articles of Incorporation and DACC Guidelines, resolved owner deliquencies, installed new playground and basketball equipment, spruced up common areas and facilities, managed repairs to the water/sewer system, and accomplished road repairs, ditch clearing, and tree removal. While unable to hold traditional in-person community events due to ongoing COVID restrictions, we were able to ensure a safe pool season.

There are still many challenges facing our community, providing opportunities for owners to participate - whether in discussions or working on projects. We are optimistic about the future with your help and contributions to the community!

The New Year also brings us two new Board members, Lisa Johnson (K-2) and Travis Martz (D-1). We look forward to the energy and expertise they bring to the Board.

Your Association needs your help to continue to meet the challenges of maintaining and improving our community. Please consider volunteering on one of our committees or projects. Please contact the Board or any Committee chair for more information (see last page).

UPCOMING EVENTS

Board of Directors Meeting	Thurs., February 17, 6:30 pm	Teleconference
Board of Directors Meeting	Sat., March 12, 10:00 am	Coolfont Resort
Board of Directors Meeting	Mon., April 11, 6:30 pm	Teleconference
CMA Committee Meetings	Date/Time /Location	Set by Committee
Board of Directors Meeting	Sat., May 14, 10:00 am	Coolfont Resort

Please check the Google Group or Facebook Group for confirmation of date, time, and location.

Weapons of Moss Destruction

from various online sources

While “green” roofs are all the rage for the environment, not so if your roof is actually shingles with moss growing on them. In our densely forested community, moss or algae on your roof is a common issue.

Algae and moss growth on roofs is an unsightly nuisance. Moss build-up can lead to roof damage or shingle blow-off if left unchecked. Algae can create ugly green or black streaks down your roof.

If you have moss on your roof, it’s because your roof is shaded by trees, allowing moisture to linger and moss to grow. Once the spores get on the roof, they gather in the spaces between shingles and grow into a spongy moss. They will grow roots directly into the shingles, which can destroy the shingles and create the opportunity for leaks.

The best time to treat roof moss is when it’s actively growing. Moss grows very little in hot, dry summer months, but it kicks into high gear during rain - growing through moderate winters and early spring months. Spring is the best time to treat moss on your roof.

Be the Boss of Moss

Keeping branches trimmed back from the roof and removing any debris that accumulates should be part of a regular roof maintenance program. If moss or algae becomes visible, clean the roof with an approved cleaner for your roof type. Your roof will look better and it will help prevent the spread to nearby houses.

Choose Your Ammo

Here is a list of several algae and moss treatments. CMA does not endorse or recommend any specific product. Please read the entire product label before use. Sometimes, a soft brushing is also needed.

- Scott’s: Moss Ex
- Lilly Miller: Moss Out! For Roofs and Structures
- BioAdvanced: 2 in 1 Moss & Algae Killer
- WMBarr: Spray and Forget Roof Cleaner
- 30 Second Cleaners: Spray and Walk Away
- Wet & Forget: Moss, Mold, Mildew, & Algae Remover



Something Growing On Your Roof?

Assessments Paid?

Assessment invoices were emailed to owners on January 3, 2022. Payments are due in January 2022 and a late fee will be assessed after January 31, 2022.

Please note that late fees are 10% of the outstanding balance ($125.00). Monthly finance charges at 6.25% apply to accounts with unpaid balances.

Owners now have the option to pay assessments with a credit card, debit card, or echeck (ACH). Use the link in the billing email.

Please note the assessment amounts for 2022:

Assessment for Houses	$1,250
Assessment for Lots	$1,250

Please contact Brenda Close at 304-258-4742 or brendac@closecpa.com if you have questions or did not recieve an invoice.

Meet the Neighbors

Zuckerman's Celebrate #50

Andy and Joanie Zuckerman (T-6) celebrated their 50th Anniversary on December 26! Joanie said, "It was an interesting anniversary... but my kids were around so that made it special!"

Congrats!



Tom Perez & Ann Marie Staudenmaier



We are relatively new owners—we closed on 19 Whippoorwill Court (E-7) in August. My husband, Tom Perez, and I have lived in Takoma Park, MD for 25 years and have 3 young adult children. We are both lawyers who have worked in the public sector for many years. We owned another cabin near Berkeley Springs for the past 10 years, but fell in love with the area around Coolfont Mountainside, so when a bigger place was for sale, we bought it. We recently sold our old cabin. We love getting out there as often as we can, and usually come at least once every few weeks. Everyone we've met at CMA has been wonderful and we look forward to meeting more of our new neighbors!



Mini, the Great Dane, checks out the snow on the Croce's deck, D-5.

Jack Wennersten



Jack (Q-9) has been busy at work with his writing career which is an ideal occupation for a pandemic shutdown. This past September he published *Strange Fruit: Racism and Community Life in the Chesapeake from 1850 to the Present*, New Academia Publishing (available on Amazon and Barnes and Noble). The book chronicles slavery and racism on Maryland's Eastern Shore in the shadow of the nation's capital. Many of you may recall tough times in Cambridge with H Rap Brown and others. In a lighter vein, Jack is finishing a comic novel about retirement life in Florida which will be out soon.



Winter sunrise, Barbara Meeker, S-3



Barn Brain Storming

Just beyond the entrance to CMA is our antique Barn with its metal roof and weathered siding. Prior to COVID restrictions, the Barn was used for community barbecues, Annual Meetings, Halloween parties and the like.

Alas, our Barn is showing its age with a drooping roofline, sagging joists, and rotting floor boards. Last fall, the Board solicited estimates from contractors to repair just the “lean to” portion of the Barn (on the back). The estimates to replace posts, joists, and floor boards were significantly beyond the current reserve funding for Barn repairs and maintenance.

The Board is looking for a group of volunteers to evaluate the future of the Barn. We hope several owners would come forward and work together to determine a plan forward and make recommendations. The Board would welcome and consider any ideas or options the group would present.

The group would need a chair to manage and take notes of meetings. They should provide updates, when appropriate, to the Board. Any owner in good standing may participate. We hope you will consider helping.

If interested, please contact the Board at Coolfont.Board@gmail.com - please put Barn Committee in the subject of your email.

Spruced Up Signage

You may have noticed many of the wooden road signs in our community have a new look! One of our neighbors has taken on the job to refurbish these signs. Each gets cleaned and a new coat of gold lettering and brown paint.

The volunteers have been repainting signs as weather permits as a service to our community. While they prefer to stay anonymous, a big thank you to them for the nice improvement to our signage and our community!



Making a Change?



If you’re making a change to the exterior of your home, please review the revised Design Guidelines & Building Regulations to determine if an application is required.

The Guidelines are available on the CMA website, under Owners/Design Guidelines. A fillable PDF form for Appendix A: Modification Application is also available online.

Questions and forms can be directed to DACC Chair, Dennis Daisey.

Servicing Your Septic System

by Cathy Levey, Acting WS Chair

On January 1, 2021, a new Septic System Maintenance Policy went into effect. By the end of 2021, all homes were in compliance with the policy, thanks to the diligence and support of homeowners at CMA. As a result, we have a only 13 homes with septic systems due to be pumped/inspected this year. (See list at right.)

As a reminder, each homeowner is to have his/her septic tank pumped no less than once every five years. Owners of full-time occupied residences or residences regularly rented with an excess of 10,000 gallons quarterly water usage are to have their septic tanks pumped every three years by a licensed septic system contractor.

There are a number of licensed septic system contractors in the area. Beddow's Septic Service is the most widely used contractor in the community.

Septic system contractors:

- Beddow's, 304-671-1773 or 304-258-1527.
- Dunham's Septic Solutions, 304-582-4645
- Gerald Taylor and Co., 301-582-2800
- Glenn's Septic, 301-678-5233
- Powell's Septic, 540-665-8196

Powell's Septic has the necessary equipment to reach septic tanks that are on a steep incline or are hard to reach, such as those septic tanks located at some homes on Bobcat Drive.

In a recent interview with Mark Ayers of Beddow's Septic Service, he suggested the best times for having your septic tanks pumped are late spring when the ground is no longer wet, summer (very best time!), and fall. Mark recommends if it's due now to late spring, wait until spring when conditions are less treacherous and the ground is more solid. If due next winter, plan to have it done in the fall for the same reasons. Mark also asks that you know the location of your septic tank when you call. If you're not certain about the location, contact Cathy Levey, Acting CMA Water and Sewer Chair at leveycathy@gmail.com or 410-718-6716.

2022 Septic Maintenance

In accordance with the CMA Septic Maintenance Policy, owners are required to periodically service their septic system. Here are the properties that require septic servicing this year. Please arrange for your septic tanks to be serviced (pumped, inspected) prior to the deadline noted.

You will need to provide CMA with a copy of your service invoice for our records. You can mail or email it to the Association.

If you have questions about servicing or the noted deadline, please contact Cathy Levey.

A-1	06/04/22	L-5	10/19/22
C-5	06/02/22	M-3	01/01/22
E-7	04/30/22	P-6	12/29/22
F-1	03/02/22	P-7	11/30/22
G-6	07/09/22	Q-2	11/21/22
I-2	11/13/22	R-8	10/18/22
K-1	10/20/22		

2022 Board Calendar

Here are the proposed dates for Board meetings for the year. Please check the Google Group or Facebook Group for confirmation of date, time, and location.

- Thurs., February 17, 6:30 pm - Zoom
- Sat., March 12, 10:00 am - Coolfont Resort
- Mon., April 11, 6:30 pm - Zoom
- Sat., May 14, 10:00 am - Coolfont Resort
- Sat., June 11, 10:00 am - Coolfont Resort
- Mon., July 11, 6:30 pm - Zoom
- Sat., August 13, 10:00 am - Coolfont Resort
- Sat., September 24 - Annual Meeting TBD
- Mon., October 17, 6:30 pm - Zoom
- Sat., November 12, 10:00 am - Coolfont Resort
- Mon., December 12, 6:30 pm - Zoom

Directory Updates



Keep your Membership Directory current with the updates noted below. We also update the PDF on the CMA website.

C-4 Joseph H Kershner — Entre Nous
(443) 801-3684 rolandparkjoe@gmail.com
Dawn Kershner
(410) 206-9610 dawnandjosephk@comcast.net
Part Time Resident

D-6 Alex Cavanagh — Lookout Lodge
(703) 403-6649 alexscavanagh@gmail.com
Jeffrey Connor Beecher
(804) 380-3523 connor.beecher1993@gmail.com
Part Time Rental

E-2 Ryan Daughtridge — The Dreaming Tree
(240) 217-3519 rdaughtridge@gmail.com
Rori Cannon
(240) 217-3515 roricannon@gmail.com
Part Time Rental

G-3 Pam Rinker — West Virginia Fling
(240) 850-9422 rekniralelmap1@gmail.com
Full time Resident

H-8 Jimmy Brinkley
(301) 667-9177 jimmybrinkley.rig@gmail.com
Part Time Rental

K-14 Robert Frommer — (Lot)
(203) 676-9677 rfrommer@gmail.com
Ashlie Warnick
(203) 668-0062 ashliewarnick@gmail.com

S-6 Eric Deglau — (Lot)
(804) 919-5740
Margaret Deglau
(804) 247-4160 maggiedeglau@verizon.net

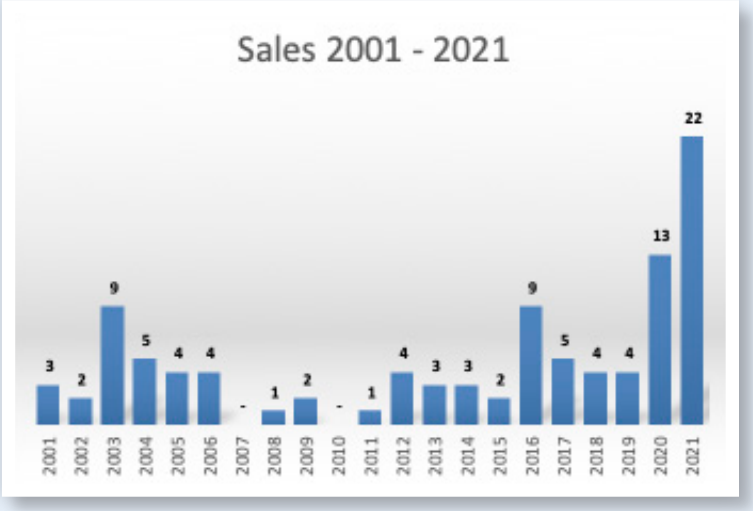
T-4 Lisa Ramish — Dandelion Lodge
(703) 568-4501 lisa.ramish@gmail.com
Dan Ramish
(703) 772-4199 dhr5s@yahoo.com
Part Time Rental

Signs of Life

Thank you to Joanie Zuckerman (T-6) for sending these fun signs. If you see one you'd like to share, send it to coolfont.news@gmail.com.







Another busy year for property sales in Coolfont!

Head of the Tax Class

By Dawne Holz, CMA Treasurer, F-1

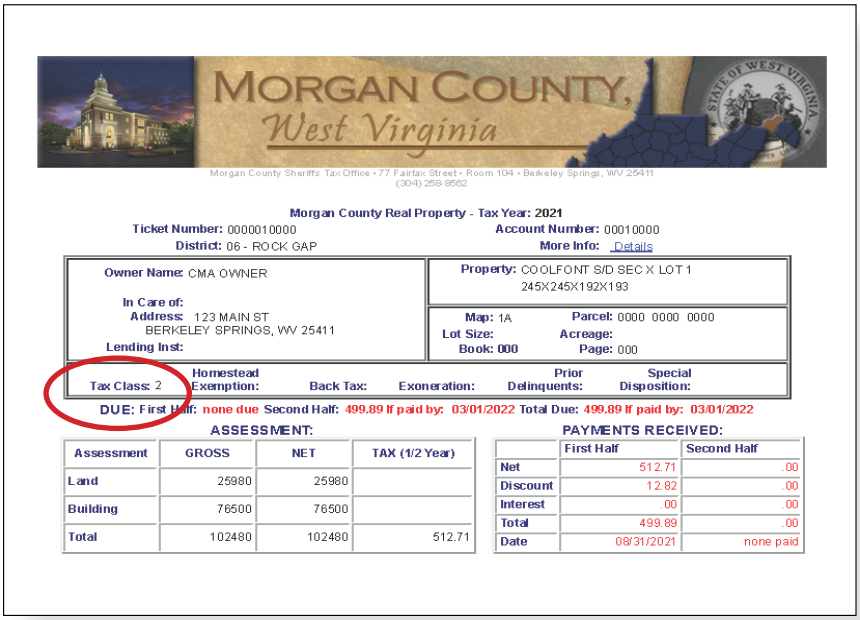
'Tis the season for real estate assessment notices and Coolfont owners often have questions about Morgan County property taxes. Particularly, the classification of properties. This information is spelled out in WV State Code, §11-8-5: *Classification of property for levy purposes*.

In short, there are four classes of properties – totally paraphrased here:

- Class I. Farm equipment and production and intangibles like notes, bonds, bills, etc.;
- Class II. Property owned, used, and occupied by the owner exclusively for residential purposes;
- Class III. Property outside a municipality, that's not Class I or II;
- Class IV. Property inside a municipality, that's not Class I or II.

So, if you own your CMA property for exclusively your own residential purposes, you're Class II. If not, you're Class III (since Coolfont is not a municipality). In checking with Morgan County, if you rent your home for even one day a year, it is not "owned, used, and occupied by the owner exclusively…" and is therefore classified as Class III.

Not sure of your current property classification? Visit http://morgan.softwaresystems.com. Enter your last name and click on the link for your 2021 tax ticket.



MORGAN COUNTY, West Virginia

Morgan County Sheriffs Tax Office • 77 Fairfax Street • Room 104 • Berkeley Springs, WV 25411
(304) 258-8562

Morgan County Real Property - Tax Year: 2021

Ticket Number: 0000010000 **Account Number:** 00010000
District: 06 - ROCK GAP **More Info:** Details

Owner Name: CMA OWNER **In Care of:** **Address:** 123 MAIN ST BERKELEY SPRINGS, WV 25411 **Lending Inst:**	**Property:** COOLFONT S/D SEC X LOT 1 245X245X192X193 **Map:** 1A **Parcel:** 0000 0000 0000 **Lot Size:** **Acreage:** **Book:** 000 **Page:** 000

Tax Class: 2	Homestead Exemption:	Back Tax:	Exoneration:	Prior Delinquents:	Special Disposition:

DUE: First Half: none due **Second Half:** 499.89 **If paid by:** 03/01/2022 **Total Due:** 499.89 **If paid by:** 03/01/2022

ASSESSMENT:

Assessment	GROSS	NET	TAX (1/2 Year)
Land	25980	25980	
Building	76500	76500	
Total	102480	102480	512.71

PAYMENTS RECEIVED:

	First Half	Second Half
Net	512.71	.00
Discount	12.82	.00
Interest	.00	.00
Total	499.89	.00
Date	08/31/2021	none paid

Why do Class III/IV pay double?

Properties designated as Class III and IV are levied property taxes that are double the rates for Class II. When we inquired with the county as to why they were twice the cost, we were directed to WV State Code §11-8-6: *Aggregate of taxes on different classifications; taxing units authorized to lay levies*. All the rates outlined in §§11-8-6a, 6b, 6c for public works, courts, and education showed rates doubled from Class I to Class II and doubled again from Class II to Class III/IV.

Short answer: It's the law.

Timing is everything

The magic date is July 1. Morgan County determines property class as of that date. Say you bought your home on May 1 and it was previously a rental. You won't be renting – it's just for your exclusive use. You would need to contact the county assessor before July 1 to get the classification changed from Class III to Class II. Miss that date and your taxes for the next year would be at the higher Class III rate. Bought your house on July 3? Sorry, you're stuck with Class III until the next year – but you can contact the Assessor's Office early to be sure it gets changed for the following year. It works in reverse, too. You bought a house that was Class II but are now renting. You need to notify the county for the classification change. It's important to note they check online rental listings for the area and perform door to door property reviews.

Overly Assessed?

If your annual assessment increases by 10% or more, you'll get a letter from the Assessor's Office. If you're not happy with the assessed value of your property, you can contact them at 304-258-8570 – but you must do so within 8 business days of the date of the letter.

More Questions?

If you have questions about your property classification or assessment, call the Assessor's Office at 304-258-8570 or visit http://morgancountywv.gov/Assessor/.

Phantastic Photos

A blast from the past!

A wonderful old aerial photo looking south into Cold Run Valley and over Lake Siri.

The Manor House and old tennis courts at lower right.

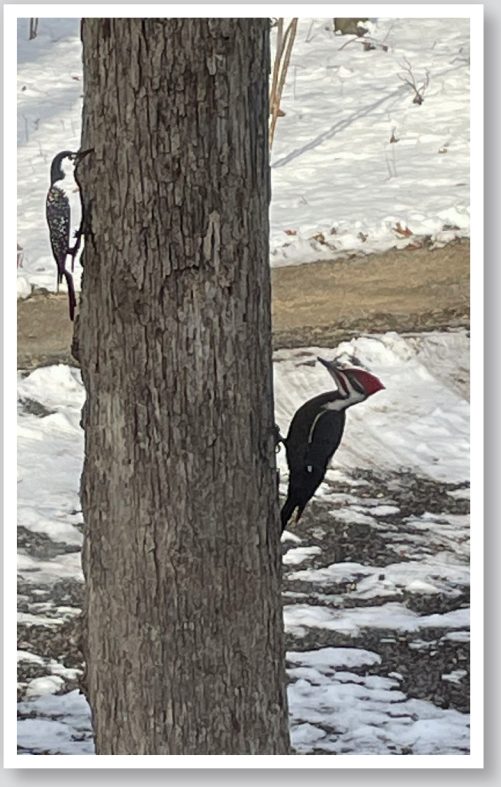
Resort and its beach and buildings in center.

Horse stables were located at lower left.





Two Gnomes hiding in the woods.



Checking out the neighbors.

Have photos to share? Email to coolfont.news@gmail.com

Board Shorts

October 19 Board Meeting

- Approved minutes of August 28 Board Meeting
- Approved contract for road work for $11,500, paid from Reserves
- Approved contract for new Mailbox Unit for $2,700, paid from Mail Center Maintenance
- Approved transfer of $9,200 in prior year assessments paid in 2021 to Reserves
- Approved contractor for Pool Plastering services for $27k, paid from Reserves

There was no Meeting in November

December 15 Board Meeting

- Approved minutes of October 19 Board Meeting
- Approved contract for Treeworks for tree removal for $4,800, paid from Forest Maintenance
- Approved snow plowing contract with SR&J (Double T) for November 2021 through March 2022
- Approved contract with Berkeley Land Surveys for property surveys on two parcels.
- Approved modification to extend Site Manager contract for one year
- Ratified motion for installation of five "Quiet Hours" signs, paid from Road Supplies
- Approved a revision to the Deferred Payment Plan for one WS account

January 15 Board Meeting

- Approved minutes of December 15 Board Meeting
- Approved contract with RK&K for Sewer Feasibility Study, paid from WS Capital Improvements
- Approved contract for $1,000 for screening fence at 343 Bobcat facility, paid from WS Capital Improvements

WOHOA
WEST VIRGINIA ORGANIZATION OF HOMEOWNERS ASSOCIATIONS
2022 MEMBER

Cover Photos: Sunrise, Dawne Holz, F-1



Snow Photos

On the Road,
Rich Croce, D-5

Snowy Landscape,
Jamie Sullivan, Q-3



Coolfont Mountainside Association

P.O. Box 418, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411

Board of Directors
coolfont.board@gmail.com
Steve Katz, President
Susan Betts, Vice President
Susan Betts, Secretary
Dawne Holz, Treasurer
Lisa Johnson, Director
Eric Lienhard, Director
Travis Martz, Director
Cindy Van Meter, Director

Website
www.coolfontmountainside.org

Google Group Email
cma-members@googlegroups.com

Google Group Signup/Web
groups.google.com/g/cma-members

Facebook Group
www.facebook.com/groups/257606361406



COMMITTEES & CONTACTS

Our committees are staffed by volunteers. They welcome any assistance with projects and events. If you would like to help, please contact the committee chair.

Site Manager - Holly Schetrompf, AHPMgmt
304-671-0882 cmasitemanager@gmail.com

Communications - Dawne Holz
Facebook - Dawne Holz
703-362-6727 dawneholz@gmail.com
Google Group - Cindy Van Meter
703-532-6862 cndyvm@yahoo.com
Newsletter - Dawne Holz
703-362-6727 coolfont.news@gmail.com
Website - Jefferson Stovall
850-339-5279 jefferson.stovall@gmail.com

DACC - Dennis Daisey
202-834-0180 dennis.daisey@gmail.com

Finance - Dawne Holz, CMA Treasurer
703-362-6727 dawneholz@gmail.com

Firewise - Heidi Splane
610-742-5774 heidianderic@comcast.net

Infrastructure Mapping - VACANT

Neighborhood Watch - Steve Katz
304-258-9329 skatz844@aol.com

Nominations/Elections - Rusty McCrady
240-723-5930 rusty.mccrady@gmail.com

Social - Holly Schetrompf & Kathy Katz
304-671-0882 cmasitemanager@gmail.com
304-258-9329 kathyk717@aol.com

Welcome - Rosemary Bigelow
304-258-5352 rosemary@mygrandmotherslace.com

Water & Sewer

Chair - Cathy Levey, Acting Chair
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Warm Springs Public Service District (WSPSD)
Mon - Fri, 9:00 am - 5:00 pm: 304-258-4118
All other times: Morgan County 304-258-0305

Join the CMA Facebook group!
www.facebook.com/groups/257606361406